

Change Management 2.0

Driving Stability Through IT Change
Management

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Agenda

- Section 1: Overview
- Section 2: Understanding Change
- Section 3: The Change Process
- Section 4: Readiness
- Section 5: Risk
- Section 6: Governance
- Section 7: Summary



Section 1: Overview

“Ensuring every IT Change protects airline reliability, safety, and operational stability.”

Overview

Purpose: Change Management ensures that changes are assessed, authorized, scheduled, and implemented in a controlled and efficient manner, minimizing disruptions to IT services while maximizing the benefits of the changes.

Why Change Requests?

- Help control and manage proposed changes to IT systems
- Provide visibility, accountability, and risk mitigation

What is a Change?

Any action that adds, modifies, or removes anything that could have a direct or indirect effect on the production environment of one or more people.

ITIL Alignment

- **Focus on Value** – Every change should deliver measurable benefits
- **Collaborate and Promote Visibility** – Engage stakeholders and maintain transparency
- **Keep It Simple and Practical** – Avoid unnecessary complexity
- **Optimize and Automate** – Streamline standard changes



When would a change be required?

“A change is any action that adds, modifies, or removes anything with a direct or indirect effect on production—config tweaks, patches, DNS updates, decommissions. If it can touch production, it’s a **Change**.”

Examples

- **Add**
 - Soft launch or pilot of new technology (e.g., introducing monitoring tools)
 - New hardware, applications, and services (e.g., deploying new servers or cloud services)
 - Adding a new route or station (e.g., network expansion or new VPN endpoint)
 - Onboarding a new vendor solution (e.g., SaaS platform integration)
 - Implementing new security controls (e.g., MFA or encryption policies)
- **Modify**
 - Application upgrades (e.g., upgrading ERP or CRM systems)
 - Bug fixes (especially those impacting production stability)
 - Feature enhancements (e.g., adding new functionality to an existing app)
 - Configuration changes (e.g., firewall rules, DNS updates)
 - Performance tuning (e.g., database optimization)
- **Remove**
 - Decommissioning servers (physical or virtual)
 - Deleting or retiring APIs (e.g., legacy API removal)
 - Retiring services (e.g., shutting down old email systems)
 - Removing obsolete security certificates
 - Disabling unused network routes or ports



Section 2: Understanding Change

“Defining what a change is and aligning the organization on a shared language and expectations.”

Understanding Change in IT

“Change Management ensures changes are assessed, authorized, scheduled, and implemented in a controlled and efficient manner, minimizing disruptions to the airline”



- Strategic Importance
 - Protects reliability, safety, and customer experience
 - Enables innovation and modernization without disrupting operations
- Managing Complexity & Risk
 - Enterprise systems are highly interconnected
 - Risk-based oversight ensures situational awareness and prevents unintended impacts
- Future-State Model
 - Focused on outcomes, business value, and transparency
 - Simplified workflows and automation accelerate low-risk changes
 - Enables faster, safer delivery across the organization
- Shared Responsibility & Governance
 - Change Management is a cross-functional partnership
 - IT, Security, Operations, and Business work together to ensure operational continuity

Section 3: Change Types

“Choosing the right Change Type (Model) based on risk, repeatability, and priority.”

Change Types

Standard Changes

Standard Changes are low-risk, repeatable activities with consistent success and full documentation, requiring minimal oversight.

Normal Changes

Normal Changes involve scheduled, planned work reviewed by multiple stakeholders with a required lead time for coordination.

Normal (Exception/Offline) Changes

Exception Changes occur when Normal Change lead time is missed, needing extra justification and higher-level approval(s).

Emergency Changes

Emergency Changes address critical incidents requiring immediate action while maintaining documentation and post-review accountability.

Section 4: Submission

“Preparing every change with complete plans, documentation, testing, and communication before execution.”

Submission Timeline

Change Request Triggers

Change requests are necessary for activities impacting systems, users, security, or service availability, including emergency fixes.

When to Submit a Change Request

1. Adding, modifying, or removing hardware, software, configurations, or services.
2. Deploying patches or updates to applications, operating systems, or infrastructure.
3. Implementing new features or functionality in production systems.
4. Changes to network components (firewalls, routers, DNS, etc.).
5. Adjusting security settings or policies that affect access or compliance.
6. Decommissioning systems or services that users rely on.
7. Emergency fixes for critical incidents (still documented as a change request after implementation).

Importance of Submission Timelines

Adequate lead time allows thorough review, coordination, and conflict avoidance, reducing risks during maintenance.

Benefits of Consistent Submission

Consistent submission guidelines provide predictability, improve confidence, and support stability in airline operations.

Submission Timeline (Calendar View Example)

SUN	MON	TUES	WED	THURS	FRI	SAT
			1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
	11:59PM HST All Approvals required		12:01AM HST Weekly Change Agenda sent to the IT Department ITSM reviews the changes on the agenda	1:00PM HST CAB meets to review changes on the agenda		
12	13	14		6	17	18
	10:00AM HST Change Management Weekly Meeting: Changes are presented. Change Manager approves to proceed. 11:00AM HST Approved Changes can be executed.			12.2		
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	29	30	31	

Section 5: Change Request Manifest & Output

“Evaluating the potential impact of each change so decisions are consistent, predictable, and safe.”

Change Request Manifest

Change Request (in Cherwell or ServiceNow) which captures details like:

- Description & Justification
- Risk
- Schedule
- Approvals

In addition to the details on the request, attach the following documents to the request:

- Runbook ([ITS Operations Runbook Template.docx](#))
- Diagrams (i.e., logical, physical, detailed architecture diagrams, dataflow and workflow diagrams) (*)
- Deployment/Implementation plan (**)
- Rollback/Backout plan (**)
- Test plan and validated results (**)
- Communication plan (**)
- Additional approvals (i.e., Director, MD, VP, Business)
- Other documents as needed to support the request (i.e., screenshot of no activity on a server/service if the request is to decommission a server/service)

(*) If the diagram is too complex to include in the runbook, attach diagram file(s) to the request

(**) These items are part of the request, but if the plan is too long to enter in the request form, attach applicable document(s) to the request

Change Request Manifest Output

“Change Readiness predicts success. Preparation creates predictability.”

A strong Change Request Manifest helps answer five questions:

- **Why we’re doing the Change**
 - Business outcome, problem solved, value delivered
- **What we’re doing**
 - Brief, concise, clear—no jargon, no ambiguity
- **How we’re keeping the airline safe**
 - Risk awareness, test evidence, backout strategy
- **When the Change is happening**
 - Aligned timing, operational readiness, dependencies understood
- **Who is executing and who is impacted**
 - Ownership defined; stakeholders aware—no surprises



Section 7: Change Request: Decision Tree

“Evaluating the potential impact of each change so decisions are consistent, predictable, and safe.”

Demystifying the Risk Decision Tree

Do you have a Change Request Manifest? (Required before starting; 24 hours after for Emergency Changes)

Does it impact a Ground Stop or Customer-Facing (Day of Travel) app? → Yes = HIGH

Does it impact a Shared Service? → Yes = HIGH

If it fails, who is impacted?

→ All Users = HIGH

→ Some Users = MEDIUM

How well was it tested?

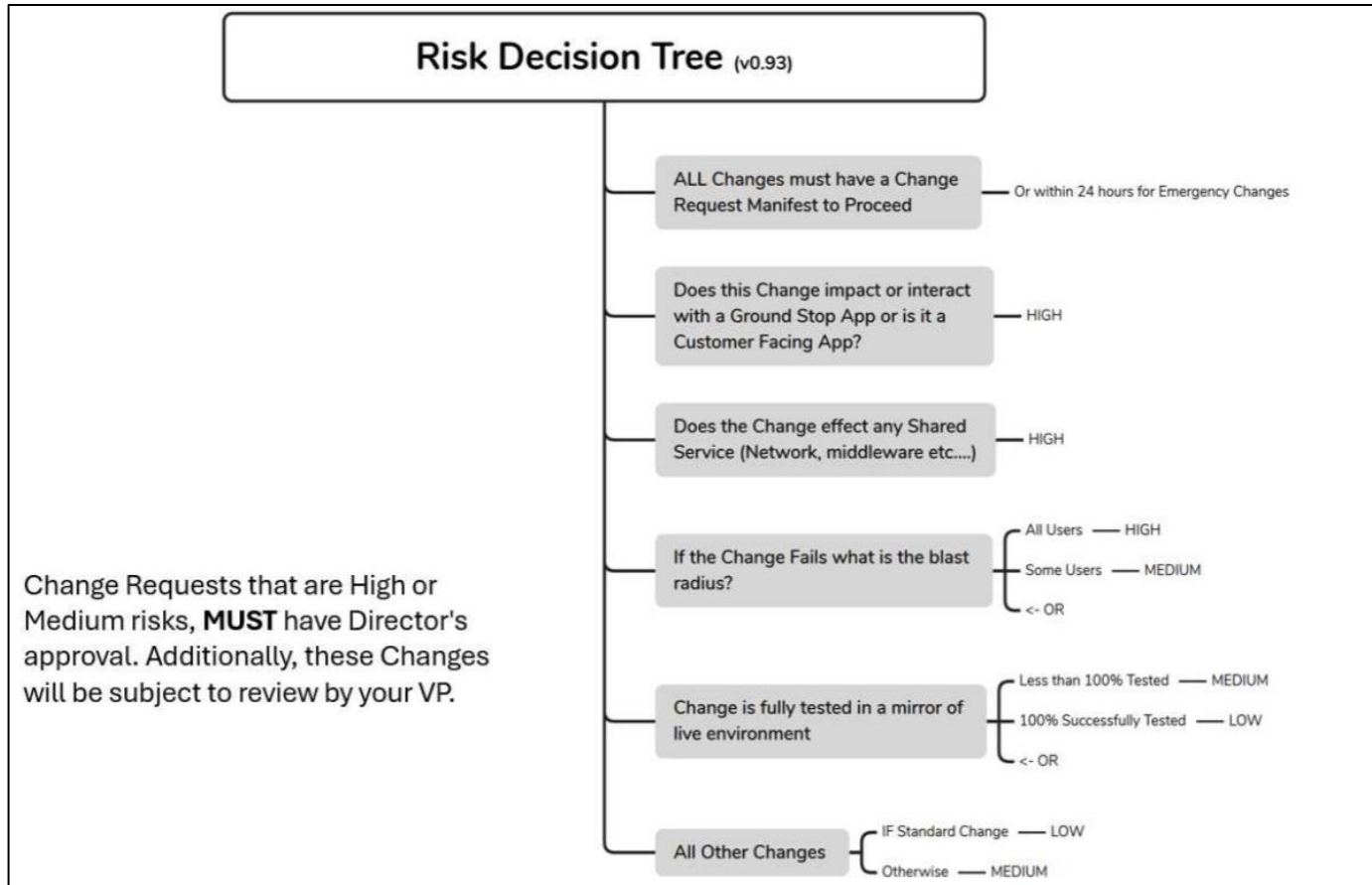
→ Fully mirrored = LOW

→ Not mirrored or incomplete testing = MEDIUM

Is it a Standard Change?

→ Yes = LOW

→ No = MEDIUM



Section 8: Governance

“Providing structured oversight to balance innovation with operational stability.”

Purpose of CAB (Change Advisory Board)

“CAB exists to protect stability, ensure cross-team alignment, and make sure every change is evaluated through risk, impact, and timing. It’s our governance function for safe change.”

CAB Governance Role

CAB functions as a cross-functional decision-making body ensuring service stability and continuous improvement.

Primary Responsibilities

CAB assesses change requests, evaluates risks, authorizes changes, and communicates clearly with stakeholders.

Balancing Agility and Stability

CAB balances innovation with reliability, allowing adaptation without compromising safety or service quality.

Continuous Improvement Insights

CAB identifies risks and gaps over time, supporting standardization, automation, and enhanced decision-making.



Goals of CAB

“We’re standardizing how we assess changes, approve changes, evaluate risk, communicate impact, and review outcomes. CAB is how we balance agility with operational stability.”

Assess Change Requests

Review proposed changes for completeness, feasibility, and alignment with business objectives.

Evaluate Risks and Impact

Analyze potential risks, dependencies, and impact on services, users, and compliance.

Authorize Changes

Approve or reject changes based on risk, benefit, and resource availability.

Ensure Communication and Transparency

Keep stakeholders informed about upcoming changes and their implications.

Maintain Service Stability

Prevent disruptions by ensuring changes are scheduled and implemented in a controlled manner.

Promote Best Practices

Align changes with ITIL principles and organizational standards.

Continuous Improvement

Review post-implementation results and lessons learned to improve future change processes.

Section 9: Summary

“Bringing together process, culture, and accountability to make change safe, visible, and reliable.”

Summary

Keep the Main Thing, the Main Thing!

Running a safe, secure, reliable airline and operation

1. Align Change with Core Values

- Safety, integrity, collaboration, performance, and excellence.

2. Effectively Prepare Your Change

- Thorough planning, testing, and readiness checks.

3. Understand Risks and Backout Plans

- Backout strategy is more critical than implementation

4. Collaborate and Communicate

- Engage all stakeholders early and keep customers informed.

5. Maintain Change Request Manifest Discipline

- Runbooks, diagrams, and test results must be accurate and current.



IT Change Management is about Ready, SAFE, Go!



Thank you



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